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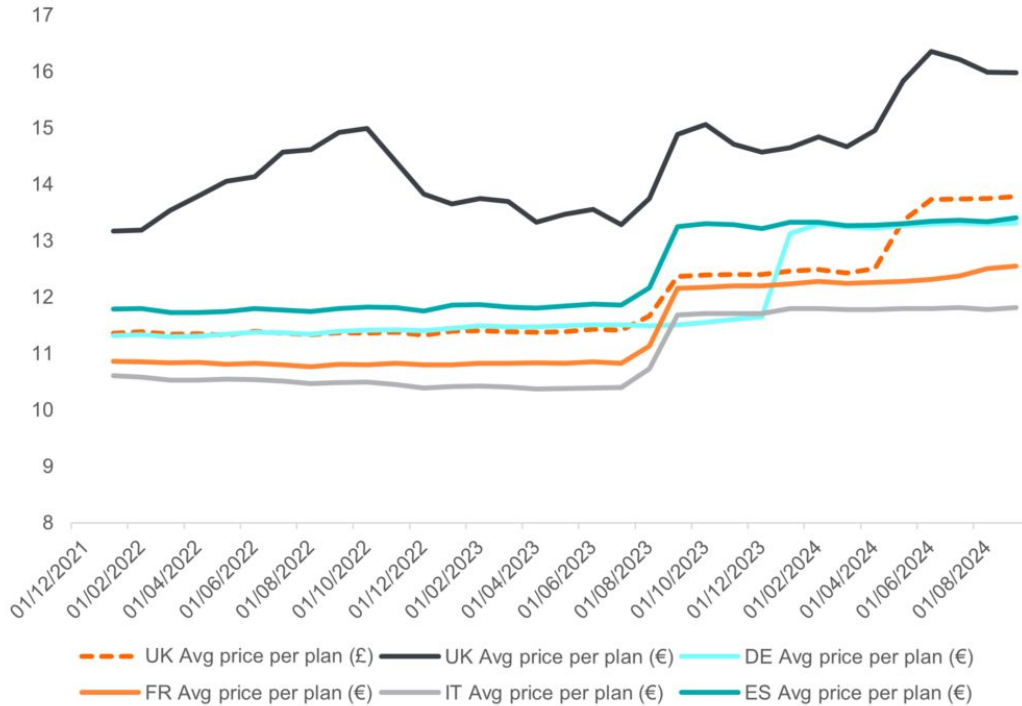


Listening Under Scrutiny: User Perspectives on Spotify and Music Consumption

Huda Jafri



Fable Data - Spotify avg price per plan per month



How do Bluesky users discuss **Spotify** and their relationship to music streaming platforms? To what extent do conversations move **beyond price** to broader concerns about value and participation?

The price of Premium is changing from \$9.99/month to \$10.99/month.

Since you're already on Premium, you'll pay \$9.99 until your billing date in September, when your subscription will go up to the new price.

OK, GOT IT



Data Collection



Platform

Bluesky

Method: Search API

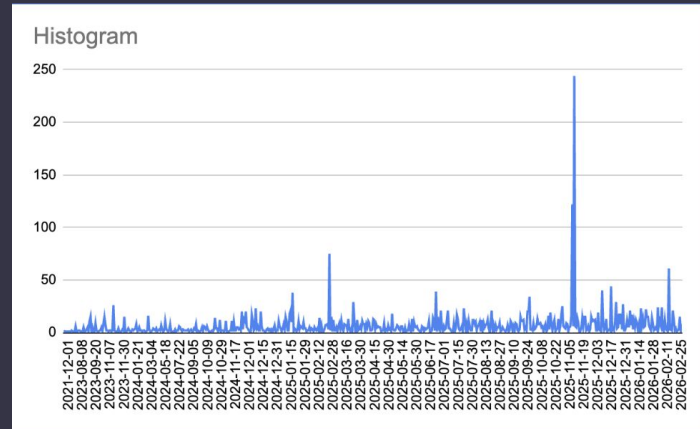
Keywords:

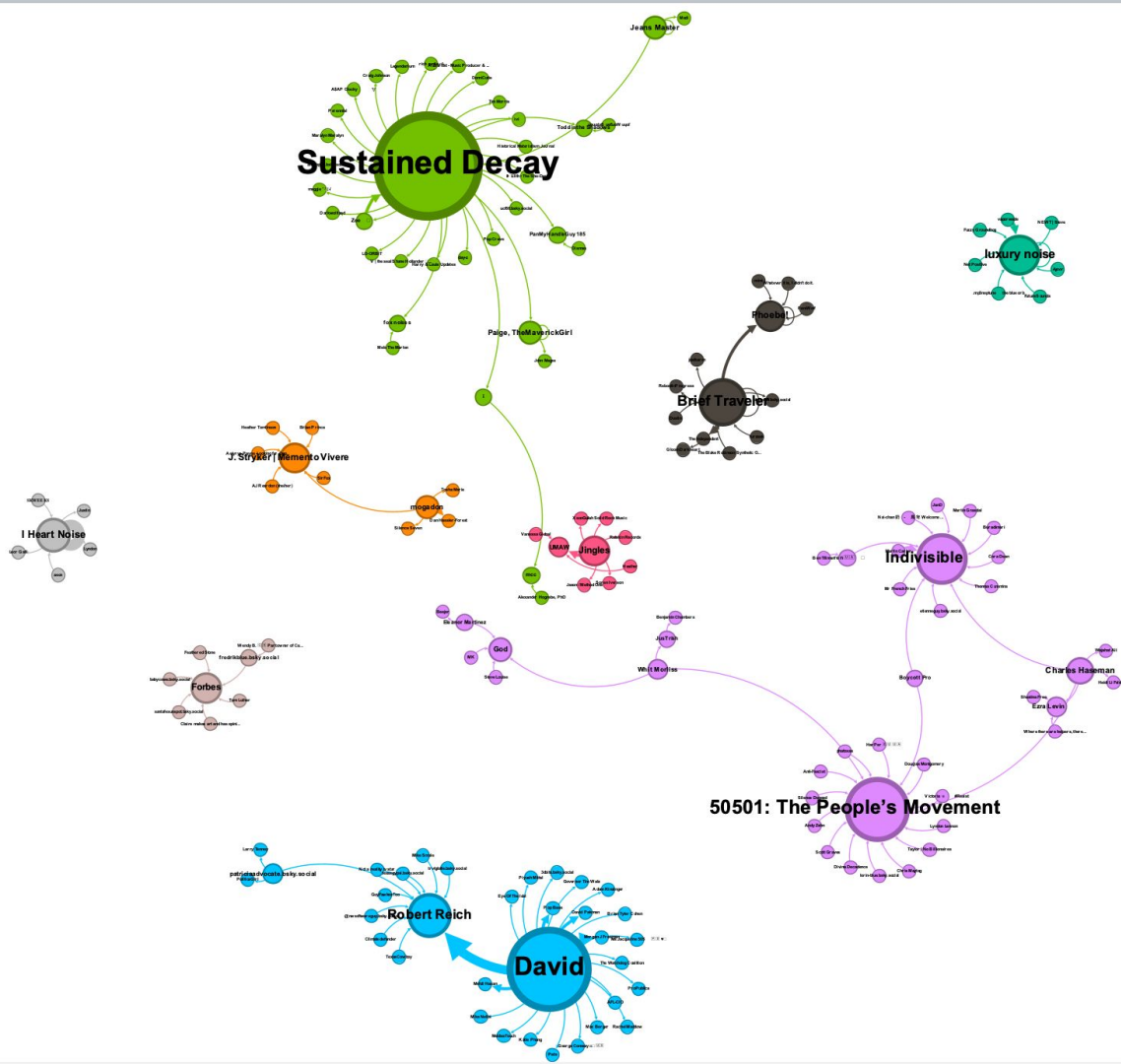
- "Spotify price increase"
- "Spotify AND vinyl"
- "Spotify AND subscription"
- "Spotify AND owning"
- "Spotify AND ownership"
- "Spotify AND own"
- "Spotify AND ipod"
- "Spotify AND Bandcamp"

Dataset

11,894 → 11,450 → 4,095 posts

original → removing duplicates → conversational filtering





Nodes = users
Edges = replies

Fragmented
clusters

Limited
interaction
across groups

[illegible]



Spotify Critique is Ethical, Not Just Economic



★ vorsprung durch zauberkraft ★

@inobscurity.bsky.social

+ Follow

they pay musicians an absurdly tiny pittance while frequently increasing their subscription fee.

they pay actual money to far-right podcasters.

also it's not specific to spotify, but a lot of people are realising that streaming services are essentially landlords but for culture, and renting sucks

7:45 AM · Dec 4, 2025



FutureSounds 🎧

@futuresounds.bsky.social

+ Follow

For us, it's vinyl, tapes, CDs and Bandcamp...Spotify is in the mix, but prefer to contribute to making artists actual money.

2:45 AM · Nov 23, 2024

- Users focus on **artist compensation**
- Price increase **intensifies** concern, not main issue

Users question fairness, not just cost



Critique Without Change: Identity & Fragmentation



A\$AP Clocky @amandak6647.bsky.social · 4mo

It's amazing how people will contort themselves into knots to insist they need to use Spotify.

Also, if I see you posting Spotify Wrapped I'm blocking you.



Brief Traveler
@brieftraveler.bsky.social

+ Follow

Sign up for Tidal, Qobuz, Bandcamp, CDs, vinyl, and/or local library. It's time to drop Spotify and you can transfer all your playlists and liked songs over easily

2:19 PM · Dec 15, 2025



Buradimari
@buradimari.bsky.social

+ Follow

I've never had a Spotify subscription and I haven't used Spotify since my son was a baby.

4:43 PM · Nov 3, 2025

- Non-use as **identity**
- **Flex culture**
- Alternative practices are **fragmented**, no unified movement

Expression seems to dominate over action



Conclusions



How do Bluesky users discuss Spotify and their relationship to music streaming platforms?
Discourse focuses on ethics, identity, and finding alternatives

3:15



Limitations

ICE-related posts skew data, lack of timeline filtering

3:20



Future Questions

Does/Can awareness lead to action?

3:10

